

looked at it that way. I was on a mission to learn the dessert business; I was grateful for the opportunity to learn it on someone else's "ticket" and make some pocket change to boot.

During my tenure as the pie busboy, I spent as much time as possible shootin' the doo-doo with the manager about revenues and profits, checking boxes to find out the names of the suppliers, and helping the baker at 4:00 a.m., to learn about equipment, ingredients, and problems that could occur.

A full week went by and I guess I was pretty good at my job, because the manager sat me down, fed me some pie (yuck!), and